

Meta Ads: Benchmarks & Business Numbers

Define the business numbers first. Then check each funnel stage top to bottom and fix the first one that fails.

1 Business numbers to define (per client)

Number	How to get it	Example	Client
AOV	Revenue ÷ orders (Shopify)	\$100	
Costs per order	Product + fulfilment + payment fees	\$30 + \$5 + \$5 = \$40	
Margin per order	$AOV - \text{costs per order}$	\$60	
Break-even CPA	$= \text{margin per order}$	\$60 (you earn \$0)	
Break-even ROAS	$AOV \div \text{margin}$	$100 \div 60 = 1.67x$	
Acceptable (target) CPA	Low enough to leave the profit you want	\$30-40 → \$20-30 profit/order	
Target ROAS	$AOV \div \text{target CPA}$	2.5-3x = scale zone	
Goal	Profit-first or growth-first	Growth: scale while > 3x	
LTV & payback	Repeat revenue per customer; days until CAC is earned back	High LTV = can accept a thinner 1st order	
Daily budget → ads live	~\$30 → 1-3 ads · \$100-700 → 2-5 · \$1,000+ → more	85% new people · 15% retargeting	

2 Benchmarks through the funnel

Stage	Metric	Formula	Healthy	If it fails, fix
Attention	CTR (all)	$\text{clicks} \div \text{impressions}$	$\geq 2-3\%$	Hook, first frame of the ad
Interest	Link CTR	$\text{link clicks} \div \text{impr.}$	$\geq \frac{1}{2}$ of CTR (all)	Message, offer, CTA, ad copy
Cost	CPM	$\text{spend} \div \text{impr.} \times 1,000$	~\$28-30 \$50-70 new pixel	Judge together with CTR, never alone
Cost	CPC	$\text{spend} \div \text{link clicks}$	As low as possible	Cut costly ads; \$1 → \$0.50 doubles revenue
Site	Page load	$\text{page views} \div \text{link clicks}$	Small gap	Page speed, tracking, mobile
Site	Add-to-cart rate	$\text{carts} \div \text{page views}$	$\geq 10\%$	Ad-page match, reviews, price, bolder CTA
Checkout	Cart → checkout	$\text{checkouts} \div \text{carts}$	$\geq 50\%$	Surprise shipping, upsell clutter, hidden button
Checkout	Checkout → purchase	$\text{purchases} \div \text{checkouts}$	$\geq 50\%$	Payment options, trust, 5%-off retargeting
Result	CVR (site)	$\text{purchases} \div \text{sessions}$	~2% average 6-10% strong	Fix the weakest step above
Result	CPA / ROAS	$\text{spend} \div \text{purchases}$	$\leq \text{target CPA}$ $< \text{break-even}$ $= \text{loss}$	Raise AOV first (bundles, shipping threshold)

3 What changes by account phase

Testing

Judge each ad only after **1,000+ impressions** (800 on a new pixel). Winner = passes CTR + link CTR and gets carts or sales. Ignore ROAS on tiny spend.

Optimising

Walk the funnel above and fix the **first** failing stage only. Then test the landing page and audiences, one at a time.

Scaling

Only when ROAS is $\geq$ **target** (**≈1.5x break-even**). Add \$10-20/day at a time. Retargeting stays at 10-20% of budget.

Benchmarks from 5 Sergio C (ADVT Media) videos, Sep 2026. "Scale at ≈1.5x break-even" is derived from his example (1.67x break-even → scale above 2.5-3x). Yellow = fill in per client.